FUNDISHOP

AGILE TEAM CHARTER

Service Marketplace Platform

Cape Peninsula University of Technology

Diploma in Information and Communication Technology | Version 1.2 | Status: Ready for team sign-off

Student Number	Team Member	Assigned Role
230117015	Kabelo Moloko	Scrum Master / Project Coordinator
230126669	Lisakhanya Mpahla	Product Owner
219117675	Christian Hakizimana	Backend & Database Developer
221084096	Muhammad Siddeeq Rabin	Frontend Developer / QA Tester

Prepared for project planning and team alignment

1. Project Overview

FundiShop is a web-based service marketplace that connects homeowners with skilled local professionals, known as Fundis. Homeowners can search for service providers, request services and track their bookings. Fundis can manage their profiles and respond to booking requests, and administrators oversee users and platform activity.

Project Detail	Description
Project	FundiShop – Service Marketplace Platform
Methodology	Agile Scrum, delivered in short sprints
Technology	React, JavaScript and CSS (frontend); Java Spring Boot REST APIs (backend); MySQL (database)
Team size	4 members (see Section 4)
Tools	Trello (backlogs and sprint board), GitHub (source code and pull requests)
User roles	HOMEOWNER, FUNDI, ADMIN
Review cycle	At project commencement, after the first sprint retrospective, and whenever significant changes occur

2. Project Vision

Our vision is to build a reliable, accessible and user-friendly online marketplace that makes it easy for homeowners to find trusted professionals and manage service bookings, while helping Fundis connect with customers and manage their work.

For homeowners who struggle to find trustworthy help, **and** Fundis who want a steady stream of customers, **FundiShop is** a secure, easy-to-use platform that simplifies finding, booking and managing local home services.

3. Team Mission and Objectives

Our mission is to collaboratively design, develop, test and deliver a working FundiShop application that meets the needs of homeowners, Fundis and administrators.

Product objectives

- Build a responsive, user-friendly React interface that works on desktop and mobile screens.
- Implement secure registration and login, with role-based access for HOMEOWNER, FUNDI and ADMIN users.
- Allow homeowners to search for and choose suitable Fundis.
- Enable homeowners to create bookings and track their status.
- Allow Fundis to manage their profiles and respond to booking requests.
- Allow administrators to oversee users and platform activity.
- Store and retrieve application data reliably using MySQL.

Team objectives

- Deliver a working, demonstrable increment at the end of every sprint.
- Test continuously and fix defects in the sprint in which they are found.
- Keep Trello and GitHub up to date so progress is visible to everyone at any time.
- Share knowledge so that no part of the system is understood by only one person.

How we will know we have succeeded

The project is successful when all Must-have user stories meet the Definition of Done, a homeowner, a Fundi and an administrator can each complete their main journey from start to finish, no critical defects remain open at final submission, and every member's contribution is visible in Trello, GitHub and the Agile logbook.

4. Team Roles and Responsibilities

Each member has a primary role, and everyone also contributes to development, testing, documentation and teamwork as needed.

Team Member / Role	Student No.	Key Responsibilities
Kabelo Moloko Scrum Master / Project Coordinator	230117015	Facilitates sprint planning, stand-ups, reviews and retrospectives; tracks progress and deadlines; removes blockers; keeps the Agile logbook up to date; supports communication and resolves conflicts (Section 9).
Lisakhanya Mpahla Product Owner	230126669	Defines and clarifies requirements; writes and prioritises the product backlog; sets acceptance criteria with the team; accepts or rejects completed work; makes sure features deliver value to homeowners and Fundis.
Christian Hakizimana Backend & Database Developer	219117675	Builds the Spring Boot REST APIs and business logic; designs and maintains the MySQL entities, relationships and data integrity; implements authentication and booking functionality; documents the API.
Muhammad Siddeeq Rabin Frontend Developer / QA Tester	221084096	Builds the React interface, navigation, forms and dashboards; tests user flows, reports defects and verifies fixes and usability.

Shared responsibilities

- Everyone attends the Agile events, updates their Trello cards and commits their work to GitHub.
- Everyone reviews at least one teammate's pull request each sprint.
- Everyone helps with documentation and testing when the sprint needs it.

Keeping testing independent

Because the Frontend Developer is also the QA Tester, no one signs off their own work alone. Frontend features are verified by a second member, backend and database work is tested by the frontend/QA member, and the Product Owner confirms acceptance criteria before a story moves to Done.

5. Core Values

Value	What it looks like in practice
Commitment	We work towards our sprint goal and finish the tasks we pick up, or tell the team early if we cannot.
Openness	We share progress, problems and risks honestly, including when something went wrong.
Respect	We listen to every member's ideas, give feedback on the work and not the person, and value each role equally.
Collaboration	We pair up on hard problems, share what we learn and help teammates who are stuck.
Continuous improvement	We act on feedback, test results and retrospectives, and agree one or two concrete improvements each sprint.
Quality	We write readable, maintainable, tested code and review each other's work before it is merged.
Customer focus	We prioritise the features that give the most value to homeowners and Fundis.

6. Communication and Meeting Plan

We work in one-week sprints. Our Agile events are:

Event	Purpose	Length / frequency	When and how
Sprint planning	Agree the sprint goal, select backlog items and break stories into tasks.	Up to 1 hour, start of each sprint	Day, time, venue or Teams
Daily stand-up	Each member answers: what I did, what I will do next, what is blocking me.	10 minutes, daily	Time, in person or WhatsApp call
Backlog refinement	Product Owner clarifies stories, adds acceptance criteria and the team estimates effort.	30 minutes, once per sprint	Day and time
Sprint review	Demonstrate the working increment and accept or reject it against the Definition of Done.	30 minutes, end of each sprint	Day and time
Sprint retrospective	Discuss what went well and what to improve; record one or two actions in the Agile logbook.	30 minutes, after each review	Day and time

Entries highlighted in yellow are proposed defaults for the team to confirm or edit before sign-off.

Tools and channels

Purpose	Tool
Backlogs, sprint board and task tracking	Team Trello board
Source code, branches and pull requests	Team GitHub repository

Purpose	Tool
Quick messages and reminders	WhatsApp group
Meetings when not on campus	Microsoft Teams or WhatsApp call
Documents and the Agile logbook	Shared folder (OneDrive or Google Drive)

Communication norms

- Reply to team messages within 24 hours.
- Raise a blocker the same day instead of waiting for the next stand-up.
- Tell the team in advance if you will miss a meeting, and send a written update.
- If power or internet fails, message the team and push your work to GitHub as soon as you are back online.
- Record important technical decisions and requirement changes in Trello or the shared documents.

7. Agile Working Agreements

Planning and backlog

- Write user stories as “As a [role], I want [feature], so that [benefit]” and add acceptance criteria before a story enters a sprint.
- Break stories into tasks small enough to finish in one to two days.
- Prioritise by value to users (Must, Should, Could) and reassess when new requirements or technical issues appear.
- Limit work in progress: finish or block your current card before starting a new one.

Coding and Git

- Keep all code in the team GitHub repository and work in feature branches; do not push directly to the main branch.
- Open a pull request for every change and have at least one other member review it before merging.
- Use clear commit messages, for example “Add booking status endpoint”.
- Pull the latest main branch before starting new work.
- Agree API contracts (endpoints and request and response formats) before the frontend and backend build features that depend on each other.
- Announce changes to shared files or the database schema in the team chat before merging.

Testing and quality

- Test your own work before opening a pull request.
- Have someone other than the author verify each feature, and fix defects within the sprint.
- Re-test the main user journeys before every sprint review.

Documentation and accountability

- Update Trello cards and the Agile logbook after each meeting and keep the README and API notes current.
- If you cannot finish a task, say so at the stand-up so the team can help or reallocate it.
- Repeated missed commitments are discussed at the retrospective first and then handled through Section 9.

8. Decision-Making Process

Type of decision	Who decides	How
What to build and in what order	Product Owner	Consults the team on effort and risk, then sets the priority in the product backlog.
How we work (events, tools, process)	Scrum Master, with the team	Proposes changes; the team agrees them at the retrospective.
Technical choices in one area	The developer who owns that area	Explains options and trade-offs to the team, then decides and records the decision.
Choices affecting several areas (API design, database schema)	Whole team	Discuss and aim for consensus; if the team is split, vote, and the Product Owner or Scrum Master casts the deciding vote for their area.

Significant decisions are recorded in Trello or the Agile logbook so we do not have to revisit them.

9. Conflict Resolution

When disagreements arise, we follow these steps in order:

1. **Talk directly.** The people involved discuss the issue respectfully, focusing on the problem and not the person.
2. **Bring it to the team.** Raise it at a stand-up or retrospective and use the requirements, evidence and our agreed standards to guide the decision.
3. **Facilitate a compromise.** The Scrum Master helps the team find a practical solution and records the outcome. If the conflict involves the Scrum Master, the Product Owner facilitates.
4. **Escalate.** If it is still unresolved after one sprint, we ask the lecturer or project supervisor for guidance.

10. Definition of Ready and Definition of Done

A story is ready for a sprint when

- It is written as a user story and has acceptance criteria.
- The Product Owner has prioritised it and the team understands it.
- The team has estimated it and it can be finished within one sprint.
- Any dependencies on other stories or APIs are identified.

A story is done when

- All acceptance criteria are met and the feature works as intended with the rest of the application.
- The code is committed to a feature branch, reviewed through a pull request and merged into main.
- Functional tests have passed and no critical defects remain open.
- Someone other than the author has verified the feature.
- Relevant documentation, such as API notes, is updated.
- The Product Owner has accepted it and the Trello card is moved to Done with its checklist complete.

11. Risks and Mitigation

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Frontend and backend integration problems	Medium	High	Agree API contracts early and test endpoints regularly.	Christian and Muhammad
Database errors or data loss	Low	High	Validate data, keep backups and test database operations.	Christian
Development delays	Medium	High	Prioritise essential features and monitor sprint progress.	Kabelo
Security vulnerabilities	Medium	High	Apply authentication, authorisation and input validation.	Christian
Changing or unclear requirements	Medium	Medium	Maintain a prioritised backlog and review changes with the team.	Lisakhanya
Insufficient testing	Medium	High	Reserve testing time in every sprint and use independent verification.	Muhammad
Unbalanced workload or member unavailable	Medium	High	Share tasks fairly, flag absences early and cross-train on key areas.	Kabelo
Merge conflicts and overwritten work	Medium	Medium	Use feature branches, pull requests and regular pulls from main.	All members
Power or internet interruptions	Medium	Medium	Commit often, work offline where possible and update the team.	All members

12. Commitment Statement

The FundiShop team commits to working collaboratively, communicating openly and applying Agile principles throughout development. Each member agrees to deliver their assigned responsibilities, support shared goals, attend team events, respect the working agreements above and help deliver a reliable, usable application.

13. Charter Review and Approval

This charter is reviewed at project commencement, after the first sprint retrospective and whenever team responsibilities, objectives or working practices change significantly. By signing below, each member confirms that they have read and agree to this charter.

Full Name	Student No.	Role	Signature and Date
Kabelo Moloko	230117015	Scrum Master / Project Coordinator	
Lisakhanya Mpahla	230126669	Product Owner	
Christian Hakizimana	219117675	Backend & Database Developer	
Muhammad Siddeeq Rabin	221084096	Frontend Developer / QA Tester	

Version	Description
1.0	Initial charter template.
1.1	Team members and roles added.
1.2	Added meeting plan, tools, working agreements, Definition of Ready, decision and escalation rules, and risk owners.

This charter is a working agreement for the FundiShop team and may be updated when the project, team or working practices change.